deflect attention away from their critiques of what they call Israeli, or Zionist, apartheid.

In fact, this discursive technique is not new. In 1921, in an article for the *Dearborn Independent* on Jewish influence over the American financial system, Henry Ford asserted, "It was inevitable that the publication first to open the discussion of this Question should be compelled to meet the degrading charge of 'anti-semitism' and kindred falsehoods."[13] Degrading, because for Henry Ford in 1921 as for the former Mayor of London, Ken Livingstone, who in 2008 accused his critics of "playing the antisemitism card," the invocation of antisemitism is equivalent to an ad hominem attack. It is taken to be a means to demean the substance and focus of a speaker's argument, by portraying him or her as somehow superstitious or irrational or motivated by bigoted malice.[14]

All this brings to mind George Orwell's prescient remark in a 1948 essay, that "there is widespread awareness of the prevalence of antisemitic feeling, and unwillingness to admit sharing it."[15] Now, it is true that Orwell misunderstood several important aspects of antisemitism, such as its relationship to political Zionism. Nonetheless, the above observation of Orwell's was based on his assertion that "above a certain intellectual level, people are ashamed of being antisemitic and are careful to draw a distinction between 'antisemitism' and 'disliking Jews.'" This distinction provides, I would submit, an ideal entry point into understanding the character of antisemitism in our own century.

ANTISEMITISM AS A SOCIAL MOVEMENT

However consistent the foundational themes of modern antisemitism may be, in our own time we are being sorely tested when it comes to pinpointing the agency behind its present resurgence. Consequently, predicting the next steps in what Robert Wistrich has described, using the case of France, as the "endgame" is a science of the most inexact sort.[16] It is not enough to say, as many do, that the culprit—in France or in any other country—is "the left," or "nationalist extremism," or "the Muslims," or "the internet," or some combination of these. That is to confuse the multiple, overlapping expressions of the problem with the problem itself.

Inevitably, this understanding has important consequences for probing what antisemitism constitutes in the age of Jewish empowerment. Looked at from this perspective, what stands out are not the similarities with the past hundred years, but the differences.

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